

Quantitative Analyst, Yankees

Doesn't matter where you start, just get in

Make a personal website - people lie, this shows you're genuine.

A lot of development on the job - way more efficient code, accounting for bias, learn a lot, make reproducible code

For Quantitative analytics - make ML models to find stuff/leverage data or do analysis to find stuff. Use math.

Worked on reliever usage, different league wide trends, and playoff pitcher pitch usage for Yankees.

Once you get in, you can prove yourself; get connections

Got an interview with Yankees by sending his resume to someone who works for Yankees from his school. Worker was too busy to talk but put resume in and landed an interview, which he thought he bombed, but then did a project, and then got a job.

Want above average hitter over an average lefty hitter.

Since there's randomness, they don't judge so much on results, maybe Cashman uses internal metrics to judge instead, he wasn't sure.

They make sure their metrics have predictive value. League wide trends can change predictiveness of values. They constantly evaluate their processes.

Plays basketball every Monday with Fishman. 8-12 guys play, people from the analytics group probably.

Fishman is a great guy/Says Cashman is hilarious.

Casually talks to Cashman in the office. One of the first conversations with Cashman was what would you do if you caught Judge's 62 HR ball if you caught it. People forget he's a person.

No season tickets, but some comp tickets and a badge lets him get into Yankee Stadium most days for work.

The office is in Yankee Stadium. Can peek out during work day to check out the game.

Hybrid work in offseason - 3 days in office, 2 days remote

During season: In person when team is at home and remote when away

Got more access to data as his position changed.

Played college baseball, but tore labrum

Did baseball projects with R for college.

Messaged people working in sports from his school.

Baseball ops - clerical tasks

Database guy - checks data quality and other stuff

Might transition to educating players.

Quantitative Analysis Summer Associate, Yankees

Path to Job:

I connected with a school friend of mine on LinkedIn and saw that he was working for our school baseball team (we both go to the same school and we're both currently in between our junior and senior year). I asked him how he got that position and if they needed any more help, and he said they did. So I worked for our baseball team for a couple months. Just a couple hours of tedious stuff per week, unpaid, nothin crazy. But I put it on my LinkedIn and eventually some random dude DMed me asking if I would like to participate in his company's sports data challenge over the summer. I assume he just did a search for college baseball interns and found me that way. All my internship applications had gotten rejected so I had nothing to do over the summer (this was last year, between my sophomore and junior years). So I did the SMT Data Challenge over the summer, the point of which was to work on an independent research project based on the player tracking data they give you. The gist of my project was creating something like catch probability but such that it gives you probabilities every quarter second or so. So you can see the catch probability go up and down throughout the play. Anyways part of the challenge was that when you submit they send it to different MLB teams and if they like it they can reach out to you. A month passed and the finalists were announced and I wasn't one of them but then another month later I got an email from someone that works at the Yankees asking to interview me for this summer analyst position. I did one interview talking about my data challenge project for about an hour and then a while later they called me saying I got the job.

1. What is a typical day like?

For me since I'm only there for 3 months I work in person every day. For some people they work remote unless there's a home game but I come in around 9:30 every day. For my first week I was just working on like practice problems to get to know the database. Week two was entirely devoted to working on my first project. I can't go into much detail but I'm basically looking for anything that could be correlated to something I'm trying to project a couple years in the future. Lots and lots of "welp that isn't correlated at all, let's try something else." I use SQL and Python to basically do exploratory data analysis. Around lunchtime I go either with other people or by myself to a local deli or other restaurant to get lunch. I leave around 5:30 if its not a home game. On night games I leave later, usually either around 8 or just when the game ends. I get dinner at the press buffet. I've haven't experienced a home day game yet so idk what happens with that.

2. What are the challenges in your job?

Probably understanding the database. We have so much data that most things are hidden in there somewhere, you might just have to be a bit creative with where you find it. The senior analysts are very helpful for finding out the best way to query certain information.

3. What are you measured on in your job?

No idea, I haven't been measured yet. I have no idea if I'm doing a good job.

4. What do you like most about working for the Yankees?

Probably just being in a culture where people are passionate about what they do. This is the only job I've ever had besides food service so I'm just guessing but I presume that most offices are a buncha people that are like "damn I have to think about potato chip shipping logistics this sucks" and this is not that at all.

5. How are the coworkers/how is the culture in the job?

The culture is great. Very relaxed atmosphere, at least from what I've seen so far. The people are very friendly and helpful.

6. What advice would you give to someone starting out in Data Science?

I'm basically at the beginning of my career as well so I really don't know. I suppose its one thing to say you have skills and its another thing to have projects on your resume that prove you have skills. So I guess focus on applying any skills you pick up in school? Idk

7. Who else do you recommend I talk to?

Probably anyone else with the quantitative analysis title that you can find on LinkedIn. I don't feel comfortable recommending you specific coworkers because I don't know them super well and I certainly don't know them well enough to say which ones would probably respond.

Quantitative Research and Computer Vision with Yankees

1. What is a typical day like?

I'm a tenured professor, so most days revolve around research meetings with students, writing grant proposals, lecturing, and reviewing papers. My Yankees work is limited to one day a week: I join a short scrum with the analytics team, review project status, and spend the rest of the day pushing a research-oriented computer-vision project that should give the club an edge before it goes into the production pipeline.

2. What are the challenges in your job with the Yankees?

Defining problems that actually move the performance needle, working with massive multi-camera data in uncontrolled environments, and running experiments fast enough for a sport that plays almost every day. The hardest part is turning raw, noisy video into reliable insights under real-world time pressure.

3. What are you measured on in your job with the Yankees?

There's no formal KPI sheet. If I consistently deliver analyses the coaching staff uses, the Tampa player-development group adopts, and the analytics group learns from, I'm meeting expectations.

4. What do you like most about working for the Yankees?

I grew up a Yankees fan, so contributing to the organization is personally rewarding. Seeing an idea move from code to on-field application—and knowing it helped the team win—never gets old.

5. What advice would you give to someone starting out in Computer Vision/Data Science?

Master the fundamentals: linear algebra, probability, statistics, optimization, and software engineering. Solid math skills beat superficial tool familiarity every time. Then build projects that force you to clean data, write efficient code, and validate results rigorously.

6. How do the Yankees keep a former employee from sharing confidential info?

Standard MLB-mandated confidentiality and non-disclosure clauses cover proprietary data and methods. Enforcement is mainly legal—breach it and the lawyers step in.

7. Who else do you recommend I talk to?

Reach out to the Senior Director of Quantitative Analysis. He can give you a broader view of how analytics, scouting, and coaching integrate across the organization.

Sr. Director, R&D - Team Ops, Maple Leaf Sports

How did you get to where you are today?

A: com sci, boston area, 2010-11 ish soccer analytics, read Moneyball, scrape soccer data off internet illegally, soccer blog, hired by company he got data from, Optum sports, invented metrics cuz had data, consultant and media work, team operations interested in, 2015 Toronto FC started analytics department, player recruitment and salary cap, won a championship, and about 18 months ago cross sport R and D department, strategic research for Leafs and Raptors and Toronto FC, project that affects all 3 teams, hawkeye data for NBA, player tracking data in hockey and soccer in future. Biomechanics recent years, AI space recent years, GPT style things for player scouting, summarizing scouting reports, building custom embedded models for unstructured scouting data, most people getting jobs in sports analytics are specialists, hired 3 PHD biomechanics,

Data collector was first sports job, Zelas sports consultant team, sports betting do similar work, academics, federations, similar industry experience to get team ops jobs.

Predicting how the game will be played using strategy, dynamics of game, etc.

Basketball future: center of mass tracking to full skeletal tracking, a terabyte of data per season,

Need cloud engineering for data analysis, bring sports science and analytics together using skeletal tracking, bridge gap between health and data,

Already have ball tracking data, thinking more about elbow velocity that lead to the ball being close to the center of basket and other biomechanics. The market is efficient in basketball. Talent is well measured but **real opportunities are** in making players better with data.

What advice do you have for someone looking to get a position in the sports industry?

A: way more qualified people than jobs, need to be lucky, effectively communicate sports concepts to coaches and scouts, writing sports analytics articles and publishing them is really valuable. General audience of post - convince them of strategy - best tool. Use as little technical stuff as possible so you don't have to explain to coach all of the neurons. Trade off specificity for explainability. Identify pitch by velocity and movement. Better than high end tech solutions.

What are the challenges of your work?

A: political. Data scale - really big. Effectively manipulate and analyze and forecast what the coach will ask. Blend of technical skillset and communication.

Can you suggest anyone else I could connect with?

A: Carnegie Mellon conference. Much of his team at the sports expo in Vancouver. Met people at conferences that he gave jobs to. Nick Recifo.

Senior Engineering Manager, MLB

How did you decide on this career?

Chose com sci and took programming in high school - better jobs

Big baseball fan, likes functionality and problem sets

How does your work impact MLB?

Enterprise internal

Scouting and ticket apps, business ops, not much of on the field tech, accomplish all requirements of business.

What is your advice to someone looking to get into the baseball industry?

Analytics: Ex player or involved in game, MIT/big institutions, hard,

Network, research maybe through university

Software engineer: be a strong developer, not as in depth analytics, just apply and show good development, show strong development.

What are some of the problems you face in your role?

Staffing and resources and critical thinking problems, business use cases, and adjust to rule changes.

Ask depending if not close to 5: (Do you still enjoy your job?)

I love my job, love baseball, cool perks - get tickets, work in commissioner office, Auto ball strike zone.

Can you suggest anyone else I could connect with?

Deal with teams directly including analytics departments - go to sports analytics conferences - sloan, research papers or project with universities

Small data science department.

Pitching Coach, Siena

He worked for MiLB teams

Tell people about a project you did/ask for feedback on a project when you network

RShiny many teams use/Make video walking through your projects.

Communicate concepts

It's all about how you present yourself.

His Program: course on RShiny, visualization, interviews, selling yourself, etc. Sold his program to big schools like LSU and Alabama. Let him know if I'm interested. Got people from his program in the industry.

To maintain connections – grind, constantly innovate, (I think probably share projects with them).

MLB media worker

How did you get to where you are today?

A: video/media production - soccer gig. Logged soccer games for 4 or 5 years for Opta

What advice do you have for someone looking to get a position in the data science industry?

A: Get in the room with people who are in sports and let opps and connections flow from there.

What do you like/dislike about your job?

A: work on business ops. rules/governance of affiliated baseball - standardized in 2021. Facility standards. How are we generating revenue - sponsors, streaming games, media content. 116 teams do live game production. Milb streaming platform. replays/graphics and quality. Only 1 person behind the camera. Ads behind games. Up to 60 games a day. Same ad package across all games maybe to get revenue. Share profits to clubs.

MLB Big Inning - redzone - rally happening - potential clinching team - MLB Network and Pipeline working on minor league side. Hockey tried it. Prospects. Small budgets and limited staff - new

First big project and cool

Challenging - had to learn a lot about MiLB, but a lot of fun.

Work is great, but have to balance it with family life. 4 days a week in office. People are really understanding and flexible. Hasn't affected work.

Things can move slow.

Get people to think about MiLB who are used to mlb.

Can you suggest anyone else I could connect with?

A: head of data insights for Raptors and Maple Leafs. Toronto he lived. Most directly related experience and followed path you want to follow.

Statsperform and MiLB.

Strategy and research team. MiLB sized and is part of MLB now.

Let him know about MLB data jobs and he can get my resume to the top.

Let him know about MLB club jobs.

120 MiLB teams.

GM of MiLB does no on field stuff - gameday ops, concession stand, towels, ump room is good. Done by 20 diff people at MLB level.

Be open

He graduated in 2007. It took him 5 years to work in sports.

Look at sports data companies

He can chat more.

MLB Network

January and February big hiring cycle for MLB.

Make connections with the smartest people at Marist in your field.

Say you're willing to work nights, weekends, and holidays.

Look at what your boss does, if you don't see yourself doing what he does - shift directions.

MLB email address puts you to top of the list for jobs.

Need to be available all the time for baseball industry (7pm to 3am he worked)/you will work Saturday/very demanding

He worked 3 jobs on the 4th of July.

TV/Control Room work is around the clock

Doesn't pay right away - Pay isn't great was \$15 an hour for a while - went up to \$25 an hour for him

People will be willing to take your job for less money

He went on field for Yankee Stadium and Judge gave him a head nod, which kept him going cuz he wanted to quit logging

Did stuff with Yes Network - Nets and halftime highlights. Some stuff for Yankees

Sports Media positions are freelance

EVS (his position now) - playback, slow mo, see if runner is safe or out; highlight packages

Loggers do editing, graphics, and news desk.

Could get me a paid little league internship - July to August. There's other things after the internship. Could maybe get me another job for logging. Reach out in May.

Classes and stuff don't matter. GPA doesn't matter. It matters where you worked and what your experience was. Just at least pass. Said this when he graduated Cum Laude.

You're in a great spot, but Bumpy road ahead.

Bats in the ceiling and attic in Old Gartland buildings at Marist - was for people with low priority points.

Fun Day Staff Renegades internship: Paid Marist for credit and was 3B pit. Set up stuff to instruct the games and coordinate minion races. Long days. He had to stay and pick up trash after the game. Did K fest in pouring rain. Went way over his hours. Did playoffs over summer after school was out.

Racing Industry Guy

He is a we oriented person. Caring. Great sense of humor.

friend of the guy who did the opening for the Trump rally.

What is your job?

A: sales and marketing company now and doesn't sell sponsorships. Does sales. AC Delco. Helps people get jobs. Some teams call them. He tells the team all the different ways to use sponsors. Needs teams to use sponsors well so advertisers keep using him it seems. Zach entertains some ex clients. Gotta pay for autographs. Build relationships over time. The smart team uses show cars. Advertisers for their team feel like it's their team.

NS: Look up AC Delco

How did you get to where you are today?

A: bagged groceries, college, assistant manager and manager of store grocers maybe, Cornell studies for agriculture and food, big national companies for starfish tuna filet's etc, managed brokerage, Miller brewing company hired him - got 25% of the country spend millions on boat drag racing etc.

Do you have advice for getting into the sports industry?

A: got Matt from Ohio State to 1 step below the top when looking for a job, connected with top people from Merrill top 50 finance. Can send my resume to 3 people. Charlotte motors, someone else, and someone else. I think Manny Kaminsky is a Harvard grad looking to expand.

Will connect me with people who are friends with the president (Zach said similar to connecting with owners). Zach - Relationships beat money - best way for happiness (proven maybe), have trust with these people.

NS: connect with these people

NS: Look up Bob Federson Best Buy Management upstate NY

Recap:

Good connections, value relationships, and send him my resume. Be sincere, loyal, honest, do it right,

Founding partner of Freedom Sports and Entertainment

The power of who? Who knows me really well and let them know what you are trying to accomplish

Make list of people you know with organization name and LinkedIn profile

Think of brands you admire or want to work for, geography, and research businesses that aren't sports to see if they are working on sports projects

Olympic Gold Medalist Skier

Lindsey Vonn Convo.
Look into Asp.

To have success - Sacrifice a lot / work your hardest

Write about emotions

Adversity helped w/ leadership + empathetic

Be yourself / prepared in speeches - Don't rehearse too much + keep it simple

Injury gave new perspective / appreciation
Realized skiing could be taken away

Working out helped mentally + a lot more
joy

- Do stuff that makes you really happy

Important to improve skill set

Former Analyst/Project Manager, Scouting for Blue Jays

Player Dev. Internship

1. ~~Where~~ How did you end up working for The Blue Jays? Knew someone on Blue Jays, Blue Jays, Yankees, Red Sox, + others, heard back from
2. What were your daily responsibilities with The Blue Jays? Building reports ~~that~~ driving people,
 ~~also~~ sports science w/ biomechanics specialties
- dumbing down biomechanics reports
- draft + combine data - look for insights
3. What did you like/dislike about your position with The Blue Jays?
Dislike - work/life balance + pay
like

4. How can someone best prepare themselves for a job in the baseball industry?
Love baseball, get your foot in the door, + may not work out

5. What types of opportunities should someone look for as an initial internship or job?
- Take a job that makes you stand out
 - Excel, Powerpoint, Data Viz, + making reports
 - Know when to look: Fangraphs within 2 days

6. What are some of the trends you noticed across the baseball industry?
- Don't have to be a baseball guy anymore, hiring people outside of baseball, + comparing premier league, rugby farm systems

6.9 Was there anything important you learned ~~or~~ from working with The Blue Jays? ^{very} ~~quite~~ fun (relaxed) working in baseball even though less money than finance.

7. How have you been able to balance work and life demands? No planned day offs + have an outlet + bonding with others + enjoy summer weekends + fight back

Help out
Don't
Complain

8. Why did ~~you~~^{you} leave The Blue Jays?
Transition periods, politics, + pay.

#17,000 → #40,000
intern full-time

9. What are your future career aspirations?
No suit + tie to be valuable.
Young + fun team + good culture.

worked outside Cleatwater
- if not Canadian worked there

Work for Yankees ptolly live in The Bronx.

Friend works in analytics for Blue Toys in
degout.

- Analyzing Baseball Data in R
- SQL
- wordpress website on resume

Advance Scouting Assistant, Seattle Mariners

- Was with Orioles and Rays Minor League

1. How did you end up working for The Orioles?
Professor had ties w/ Orioles; got internship from someone the professor knew.

2. What are your daily responsibilities with The Orioles? Oversee Saratoga + DR complexes
Front office/P.D. Rosters, hotels, on-field throwing
promotion + denotation of players

About 190 people.

Promotions - DR. to FL to Low-A

3. What do you like/dislike about working for The Orioles?
Dislike - not enough hrs. to do everything

Like - on-field + roster management + interacting w/ players.

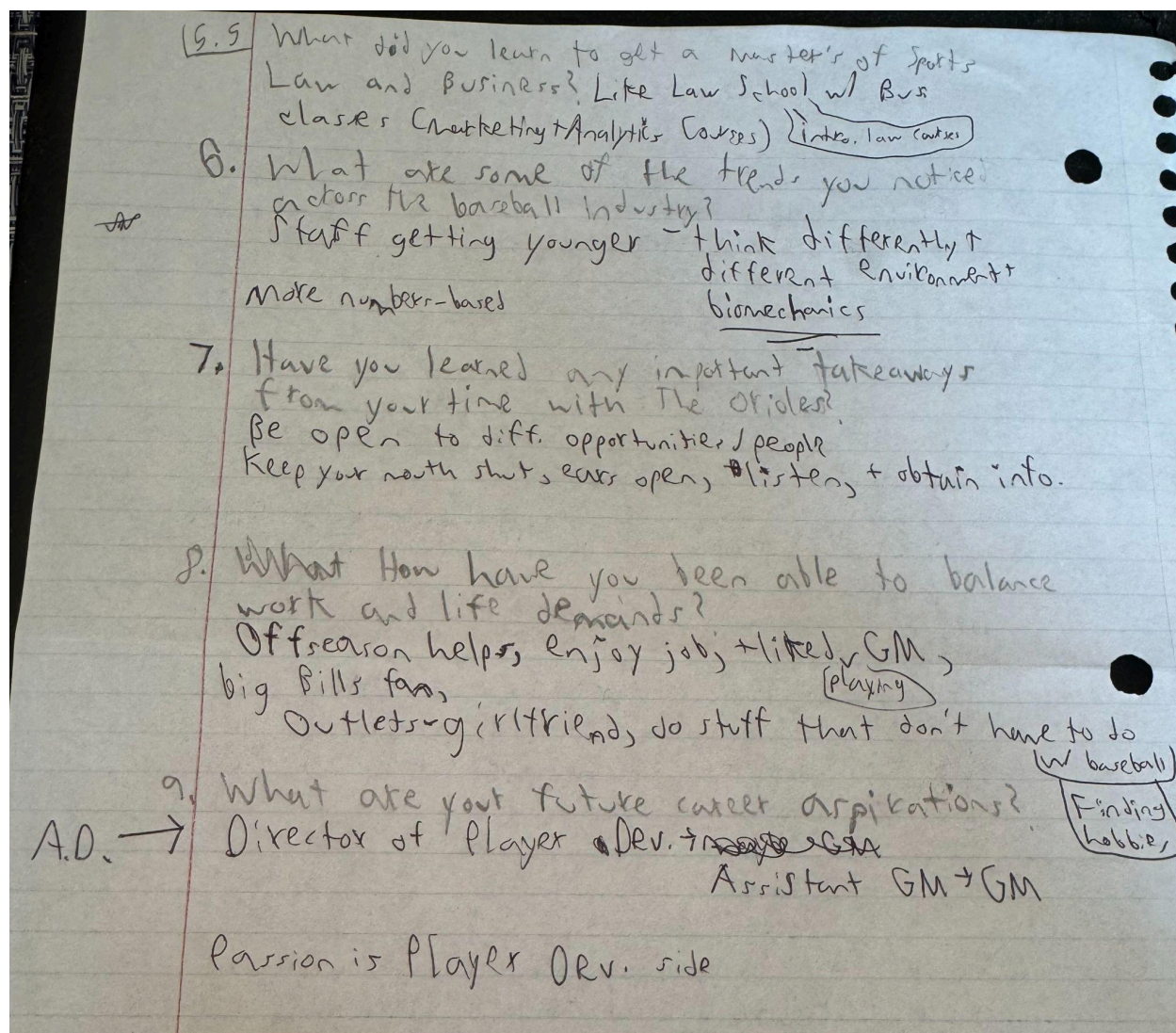
4. How can someone best prepare themselves for a job in the baseball industry?

Love it, really cool job, is a grind, very little work/life balance during the season
Expect missing things + being really busy + it can be a grind

5. What types of opportunities should someone look for as an initial internship or job?
To get into baseball, anything you can get

Look at other Player Dev. positions (not just analytics)

Get connected + exposed to game



Baseball Ops Data/Tech Assistant with Guardians

Why did you leave the industry?

Same role for 2 years, little data analysis, some tech, took initiative for analysis. Weren't adding analysts. Personal life - didn't want to move and leave boyfriend, met him from the job. Didn't want to play the waiting game. Not totally fair - hired a coach to sit in the analyst role for a year until a coach role opened up for him instead of hiring a true analyst, front office side would have been more manageable - was working 6-7 days a week. Boyfriend is half coach and analyst at MLB level. Monday through Saturday. No days off.

What was a typical day like with the Guardians?

Wanted to be in Arizona to do analysis, didn't do a lot. Get there early and pull data for coaches. 11-6 - lineup cards and scouting reports. 6-10. Upload video and data after game. 7:30, start at 9 then done at 11pm-12am. Teaching the fundamentals at instructs. Pulling stuff for

hitting. Setting up tech was 90% of the role and had to create time to analyze. Had to take initiative to do what you want. Which movement of slider - use shorter slider cuz it gets more swing and miss. Tell them how players are trending.

Operating trackman or hawkeye (a pain), just watching game maybe, tag pitches, align pitches with video. Put if the runner advanced. Hawkeye tracked player movement. Worked in extreme heat.

Had trust to talk with players, said what stood out on report to the player then talked to the coach what they saw in the report. Told them they were doing well and answered their questions.

What were the challenges in your job with the Guardians?

Biomechanical data, operate tech, create trust with coaches and players, getting things done as soon as possible

What were you measured on in your job with the Guardians?

None. Just need to be a good fit. Did 100% of responsibilities and was a good team member. Answered questions. How can we help you get to this goal instead of do xyz to get to this position

What did you like most about working for the Guardians?

The people, team oriented culture. She enjoyed the analysis she did. She thinks she could shag fly balls if she wanted, she helped pick them up in BP.

What advice would you give to someone looking to get into the industry?

Find ways to improve your skill set, write blogs, and distinguish yourself among other candidates. Do what you're passionate about.

Get really good at bad interview questions.

Current job?

SQL, Power BI, and Python. Customer Analytics. Dashboard building, reporting, and data pulls.

Who else do you recommend I talk to?

Be open to job that isn't bullet for bullet exactly the same. Knowing how coaches and players think helps in front office I think. May get back to me on a name.

Baseball Miscellaneous

Apply to R and D Analyst/Intern and Minor league video interns

Teams look for 3 things: Can you code, Can you speak Spanish, and Have you played baseball in the past (specifically at a high level)

Specialize/Always emphasize your strong suits

Take a Spanish class and watch a Spanish show with Spanish subtitles and translate words you don't know (a lot of times you work with a Dominican player)

Might have to do multiple internships before full time position

Continue to do networking calls (ideally in baseball ops)/Make connections on LinkedIn

Get LinkedIn premium/join Sunday calls with Dr Lashbrook

Email director of departments you're interested in/Send research to people you've interviewed with

Be willing to relocate/be open to other areas

Stay in place you feel the most fit/Say what you want to do in the future on annual review when in job

Try to be expert on job/get along with coworkers

Don't tell them opposing view unless they ask you/Master of Analytics for Georgia is rigorous but if you have experience with programming tools you should be good

Getting better compensated in positions/more remote positions

Want to be in-person at job/sensitive to leadership changes

Yankees used R/baseball teams open minded about tech stuff